

Algorithm for Bioinformatics

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Problem 1

In this exercise we have the following parameters:

2 Strings: $A[1..m]$, $B[1..n]$, the matching/mismatching costs $p(a, b) \geq 0$ and the opening costs g_0 , as well as the gap extension costs g with the goal of minimizing the overall total cost. We can set the opening costs to some number, e.g. 3 and the extension costs to 1. Other to the algorithm in class we use 3 different matrices to store the information, if we are opening a new gap, or extending an already existing one. We use the 3 matrices M , X , Y .

So at each position (i, j)

The matrix M symbolizes diagonal downwards movement and a match/mismatch state and consumes both $A[i]$ and $B[j]$. So every gap that was opened is closed as well.

$X(i, j)$ consumes $A[i]$ only and represents a gap in B. X can extend an already opened block, or open a new gap block from M or Y .

Alternatively Y represents a horizontal movement and consumes $B[j]$ only. Y can also extend an already opened bloc with $Y[i, j - 1] + g$ or open a new gap from M or X with M or $X + g_0 + g$.

If we are already inside of a gap, we only add g to the distance of the strings and if we open a new are starting a new gap block we are adding $g_0 + g$.

So:

$$M(i, j) = \min (M(i - 1, j - 1), X(i - 1, j - 1), Y(i - 1, j - 1)) + p(A[i], B[j])$$

$$X(i, j) = \min (M(i - 1, j) + g_0 + g, X(i - 1, j) + g, Y(i - 1, j) + g_0 + g)$$

$$Y(i, j) = \min (M(i, j - 1) + g_0 + g, X(i, j - 1) + g_0 + g, Y(i, j - 1) + g)$$

For the global alignment the cost and final answer then is

$$cost = \min\{M[m, n], X[m, n], Y[m, n]\}$$

Initialization

The first rows and columns get initialized as follows:

$$M[0, 0] = 0, X[0, 0] = Y[0, 0] = +\infty$$

$$X[i, 0] = g_0 + i * g, (i \geq 1), M[i, 0] = +\infty, Y[i, 0] = +\infty$$

$$Y[0, j] = g_0 + j * g, (j \geq 1), M[0, j] = +\infty, X[0, j] = +\infty$$

Example:

We compare the 2 sequences *ABC* and *A*.

The 3 matrices have the form of 4×2 . After initializing the matrices we get

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \infty \\ \infty & \infty \\ \infty & \infty \\ \infty & \infty \end{pmatrix} X = \begin{pmatrix} \infty & \infty \\ 4 & \infty \\ 5 & \infty \\ 6 & \infty \end{pmatrix} Y = \begin{pmatrix} \infty & 4 \\ \infty & \infty \\ \infty & \infty \\ \infty & \infty \end{pmatrix}$$

The value 4 means opening a new gap (length 1), the value 5 means extending that same gap to length 2 and 6 means extending it to length 3.

Filling in the interior:

This is computed with the rules above. So for example the cell (1, 1) is calculated with

$$M[1, 1] = \min(M(0, 0), X(0, 0), Y(0, 0)) + p(A[i], B[j]) \\ = \min(0, +\infty, +\infty) + 0 = 0$$

After filling in the cells with the rules above, we come out to the matrices:

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \infty \\ \infty & 0 \\ \infty & 6 \\ \infty & 7 \end{pmatrix} X = \begin{pmatrix} \infty & \infty \\ 4 & 8 \\ 5 & 4 \\ 6 & 5 \end{pmatrix} Y = \begin{pmatrix} \infty & 4 \\ \infty & 8 \\ \infty & 9 \\ \infty & 10 \end{pmatrix}$$

So the solution would be 5.

Each cell is computed in $O(1)$ time and we have matrices of size $(m + 1) \times (n + 1)$ so the total runtime is also $O(mn)$.

Problem 2

a)

We have the following 4 axioms $M1 - M2$ that describe a metric. We need to show that the sim_s fullfills these axioms over Σ^* .

M1

From the slides we defined that the alignments are either of the types (a, b) , $(a, -)$ or $(-, b)$.

With the costs of $p(a, b)$ or g .

- ▶ symmetric matches/substitutions matrix $p : \Sigma \times \Sigma \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ ($p(a, b) = p(b, a)$)
- ▶ gap penalty $g \in \mathbb{R}$
- $\rightsquigarrow S\left(\begin{bmatrix} c \\ c' \end{bmatrix}\right) = p(a, b), S\left(\begin{bmatrix} c \\ - \end{bmatrix}\right) = S\left(\begin{bmatrix} - \\ c \end{bmatrix}\right) = g$
- $\rightsquigarrow$ score of alignment sum of scores of columns

Since p is also a metric we can assume that $p(a, b) \geq 0$. So is g , given from the task. So every alignment has to be ≥ 0 , so their sum as well.

M2

If the 2 strings are the same, the alignment score is also 0. Indeed $sim_s = 0 \iff x = y$

Since $sim_s = 0$ and $g > 0$, no gaps can appear in the string. Also $p(a, b)$ must also always be 0, so every character must be the same. So indeed $a = b$ for every column. This means, that the 2 strings have the same lengths as well as the same characters as well.

The other direction $x = y \Rightarrow sim_s = 0$ is trivial.

M3

We need to prove that $sim_s(x, y) = sim_s(y, x)$. This is true, since (also from the slides) $p(a, b) = p(b, a)$, as well as a column $(a, -)$ becomes $(-, a)$. These also have

the same gap cost g . So for any alignment the reverse cost of flipping x and y also exists, as well as their minima.

M4

We need to show that

$$\text{sim}_S(x, z) \leq \text{sim}_S(x, y) + \text{sim}_S(y, z), \forall x, y, z \in \sum^*$$

b)

We choose the 3 letter words a, b, c and define:

$$p(a, a) = 0, p(b, b) = 0, p(c, c) = 0, p(a, b) = 1, p(b, c) = 1, p(a, c) = 3,$$

This definition violates M4 with $3 > 2$.

The gap penalty g in our example is also $= 1$

So now, if we want sim_s for all the possibilities, we find that it conserves all the axioms given by the task.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{sim}_s(a, b) &= p(a, b) = 1 \\ \text{sim}_s(b, c) &= p(b, c) = 1 \\ \text{sim}_s(a, c) &= 2 * g = 2\end{aligned}$$

$\Rightarrow$ Conserves M4.

c)

The difference to a) is that now we also handle affine gap costs.

From our slides this is as defined as follows:

↪ *affine gap costs:*

score k contiguous insertions (or k contiguous deletions) instead as $\underline{g_0 + k \cdot g}$
(usually then $g_0 \gg g$)

- If we represent contiguous insertions as $\begin{bmatrix} + \\ c_1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} - \\ c_2 \end{bmatrix} \cdots \begin{bmatrix} - \\ c_k \end{bmatrix}$
can assign $S(\begin{bmatrix} + \\ c \end{bmatrix}) = g_0 + g$ and $S(\begin{bmatrix} - \\ c \end{bmatrix}) = g$.

M1

Like in a), since p is also a metric we can assume that $p(a, b) \geq 0$. Since $g_0, g \geq 0$ and also $g_0 + g > 0$, so sim_s also has to be ≥ 0 .

M2

If we had a gap block, g_0 would be greater than 0. If we had any mismatch with $a \neq b$ the cost $p(a, b)$ would be > 0 .

Since $sim_s = 0$ and $g > 0$, no gaps can appear in the string. Also $p(a, b)$ must also always be 0, so every character must be the same. So indeed $a = b$ for every column. This means, that the 2 strings have the same lengths as well as the same characters as well.

The other direction $x = y \Rightarrow sim_s = 0$ is trivial.

M3

Is also still true and unaffected by the insertion or deletion of a block of length k , so the cost of $g_0 + kg$ is unaffected.

M4

d)

We look at the following added script operations.

↪ Allow new edit script operations (all cost 0):

- ▶ IgnorePrefix($A[0..i)$) free deletes at beginning
- ▶ IgnorePrefix($B[0..j)$) free inserts at beginning
- ▶ IgnoreSuffix($A[i..m)$) free deletes at end
- ▶ IgnoreSuffix($B[j..n)$) free inserts at end

Even if the 2 strings are not the same, their local distance can be 0, breaking M2.

Example

$$\begin{aligned}x &= A \\y &= XAX \\d_{local}(x, y) &= 0\end{aligned}$$